

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Diverse Perspectives on Justice - Complete Topic Package

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Diverse Perspectives on Justice

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1 Perspective Map, Stakes and Essential Vocabulary

2 The Eight-Perspective Chapter Spine

3 Rawls, Nozick and Controlling Distinctions

4 Thinkers and Rival Standards of Justice

5 Illustrative Cases and Evidence Units

6 The Six-Axis Comparative Matrix

7 Trap Repair, Boundaries and PYQ Routes

8 Revision Spine and Directive Control

9 Argument Reconstruction and Objection-Reply Chains

10 Indian Applications, Quotation Safety and MCQ Ledger

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Diverse Perspectives on Justice - Complete Topic Package

Subject: Political Theory **Section:** Subject-wide Syllabus **Generation:** learner-v2:g2 **Ownership:** supplementary conceptual support; no synthetic GS or Optional PYQ ownership is created. **Source policy:** complete Basic owner first; optional Advanced depth only after practice.

2026 CURRENT ANCHOR - ANTYODAYA IN ACTION

FACT: Official fact (PIB, 12 June 2026): The Government of India's *Antyodaya in Action* overview brings together targeted social-justice and empowerment interventions for disadvantaged communities. It is useful here as an official illustration of group-sensitive public action rather than as proof of any single theory of justice.

ANALYSIS: Conceptual use: Compare redistribution of resources with effective opportunity, dignity, representation and protection against structural subordination. Rawlsian, feminist, subaltern, Marxist and libertarian evaluations may reach different verdicts on the same policy.

Official source: <https://static.pib.gov.in/WriteReadData/specificdocs/documents/2026/jun/doc2026612890901.pdf>

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

SESSION 1 - Perspective Map, Stakes and Essential Vocabulary

Subject: Political Theory | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS/Optional relevance:** GS-II (Polity & Governance) conceptual foundation; PSIR Optional Paper-1 background. **Core area:** Competing rules of distributive justice across liberal, libertarian, socialist, anarchist, feminist, subaltern and communitarian traditions. **Grounded in:** O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.20, PDF pp.446-473. **Source edition/cutoff:** Fifth Edition (2009); no post-2009 fact is assumed unless independently dated and tagged CURRENT:. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference/synthesis | **CURRENT:** = dated current anchor | **WRONG:** = trap/misattribution. *Companion:* Political-Theory/advanced/20_Diverse-Perspectives-on-Justice.md.

1. One-screen conceptual map

- **FACT:** Gauba opens the chapter by treating justice as a field of many rival perspectives rather than one settled formula. (PDF p.446)
- **FACT:** Rawlsian liberal justice centres on primary goods, original position, equal basic liberties, fair equality of opportunity, and the difference principle. (PDF pp.447-450)
- **FACT:** Nozickian libertarian justice centres on self-ownership and justice in acquisition, transfer and rectification under a minimal state. (PDF pp.450-452)
- **FACT:** Marxist and democratic-socialist views shift attention from market distribution to exploitation, property relations, social ownership, welfare and democratic freedoms. (PDF pp.452-461)
- **FACT:** Anarchists attack coercive authority itself and imagine justice through voluntary cooperation, decentralization and anti-domination. (PDF pp.461-464)
- **FACT:** Feminist and subaltern perspectives insist that justice must also address structurally subordinated groups, not only formal market or contract rules. (PDF pp.464-469)
- **FACT:** Communitarians criticize the isolated or unencumbered self and relocate justice within embedded selves, shared goods and community meanings. (PDF pp.469-473)
- **ANALYSIS:** UPSC key: every justice theory answers six hidden questions—who gets what, by what rule, through which state, with what property regime, in what kind of community, and against which injustice.

2. Why this topic matters

- **FACT:** This chapter is the direct sequel to the conceptual discussion of justice because it asks how rival traditions operationalize justice in actual distribution. (PDF pp.446-447)

- **FACT:** It clarifies why justice debates cannot be reduced to one axis like liberty alone or equality alone. (PDF pp.448-450, 469-473)
- **ANALYSIS:** Gauba's ordering can be read as widening the debate from distributive fairness toward critiques of ownership, domination and community; recognition-language here is an analytical bridge, not a term attributed to Gauba. (PDF pp.446-473)
- **ANALYSIS:** In GS-II and PSIR, this topic helps distinguish welfare liberalism from libertarianism, socialism from Marxism, and communitarian critique from anti-rights rhetoric.
- **ANALYSIS:** It is also the safest way to avoid caricatures such as "Rawls = equal outcome" or "Nozick = no justice."
- **ANALYSIS:** Use this chapter whenever a question asks whether justice lies in fair procedure, entitlement, need, community, or emancipation from domination. Recognition may be added only as the separately sourced Fraser/Honneth extension in Section 13.
- **ANALYSIS:** It also helps answer mixed questions such as whether social justice requires redistribution alone or also dignity, voice and institutional belonging.
- **ANALYSIS:** In short, this is the chapter that converts the abstract word "justice" into rival political blueprints.

3. Essential definitions

Term	Exam-ready meaning
Primary goods	FACT: Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect. (PDF p.447)
Original position	FACT: Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447)
Veil of ignorance	FACT: The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447)
Equal basic liberties	FACT: Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448)
Fair equality of opportunity	FACT: Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality. (PDF p.448)
Difference principle	FACT: Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged. (PDF p.448)
Entitlement theory	FACT: Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification. (PDF pp.450-452)
Subaltern	FACT: Groups kept in subordinate, exploited or marginalized positions by structural inequalities and hegemonic domination. (PDF pp.467-469)
Situated / embedded self	FACT: Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them. (PDF pp.469-472)

SESSION 2 - The Eight-Perspective Chapter Spine

4. Core argument / chapter spine

- **FACT:** Gauba begins with the liberal perspective and presents Rawls as the major attempt to reconcile liberty with equality and fraternity within a broader liberal frame. (PDF p.446)
- **FACT:** Rawls rejects utilitarian sacrifice of some for aggregate happiness and instead asks what principles free and rational agents would choose under fairness conditions. (PDF pp.447-448)
- **FACT:** Gauba then shifts to the libertarian perspective, where Nozick opposes redistributive welfare and treats justice historically through titles and transfers, not patterned end-states. (PDF pp.450-452)
- **FACT:** The Marxist discussion rejects repair of capitalism through mere fairer shares and locates injustice in exploitation, surplus value and private ownership of major means of production. (PDF pp.452-459)

- FACT: Democratic socialism softens the revolutionary route, combines socialism with democratic freedoms, and seeks welfare plus civil liberties through constitutional politics. (PDF pp.459-461)
- FACT: Anarchism radicalizes suspicion of coercive authority by arguing that justice needs the shrinking or abolition of state power and domination. (PDF pp.461-464)
- FACT: Feminist justice makes gender hierarchy a central political problem and presses for rights, opportunities, representation and compensatory measures. (PDF pp.464-468)
- FACT: Subaltern justice reframes distribution around structurally subordinated groups whose labour and contribution are undervalued under elite hegemony. (PDF pp.467-469)
- FACT: Communitarian justice criticizes liberal neutrality and insists that right cannot be understood apart from shared conceptions of the good and community life. (PDF pp.469-473)

SESSION 3 - Rawls, Nozick and Controlling Distinctions

5. Essential distinctions

- FACT: Rawlsian justice is not flat equality; liberty comes first, opportunity next, and only then may inequalities be permitted if they help the least advantaged. (PDF p.448)
- ANALYSIS: Rawls canonically states **two principles**: the first secures equal basic liberties; the second contains fair equality of opportunity and the difference principle, with opportunity prior to the difference principle. Gauba's page 448 presents these as a three-step list for exposition.
- ANALYSIS: Benefit to the least advantaged is therefore not sufficient by itself: inequality must also respect equal basic liberties and genuinely fair opportunity.
- FACT: Nozick does not deny justice; he denies redistributive or welfare-state patterning that violates just holdings and voluntary exchange. (PDF pp.451-452)
- FACT: A current voluntary transfer is not sufficient for entitlement if the original acquisition or earlier transfers were unjust; Nozick's third principle of rectification is integral, not optional (PDF pp.450-452).
- FACT: Marxist justice is not mainly about slightly better wages inside capitalism; it targets the exploitative structure of property and surplus extraction itself. (PDF pp.452-459)
- FACT: Democratic socialism differs from Marxism by refusing dictatorship and insisting on freedom of thought, party competition and civil liberties alongside social justice. (PDF pp.459-461)
- FACT: Feminist equality is not exhausted by identical legal treatment; Gauba also notes support for maternity benefits, exemptions from certain hazardous work, and reservations to correct underrepresentation. (PDF pp.466-468)
- FACT: Communitarian criticism is not rejection of justice; it is a criticism of abstract selves, liberal neutrality and the neglect of common goods. (PDF pp.469-473)
- FACT: Walzer's complex equality differs from simple equality because it blocks domination of one sphere by another instead of equalizing every good in the same way. (PDF pp.472-473)
- ANALYSIS: Subaltern justice extends distributive debate from class alone to multiple entrenched forms of subordination such as caste, gender, region, religion and culture.

SESSION 4 - Thinkers and Rival Standards of Justice

6. Thinkers and positions

Thinker / stream	Position in this topic
John Rawls	FACT: Justice as fairness through two lexically ordered principles: equal basic liberties; then fair opportunity plus the difference principle, chosen in the original position. Gauba explains the second principle's two parts as separate steps (PDF pp.447-450).
Robert Nozick	FACT: Justice as entitlement grounded jointly in self-ownership, just initial acquisition, voluntary transfer and rectification under a minimal protective state (PDF pp.450-452).
Marx and Engels	FACT: Capitalist injustice lies in exploitation of labour, surplus value and private ownership of major means of production; communist society aims to end class domination. (PDF pp.452-459)
Harold Laski / E.F.M. Durbin	FACT: Democratic socialism combines socialist justice with democratic method, civil liberties and public services. (PDF pp.459-461)
Godwin / Proudhon / Bakunin / Kropotkin / Tolstoy / Gandhi / Bookchin	FACT: Anarchist family members differ, but all distrust coercive authority and seek justice through decentralized, voluntary or morally regenerated association. (PDF pp.461-464)
Mary Wollstonecraft / J.S. Mill	FACT: Early feminist demand for equal rights, education, property and political citizenship for women. (PDF pp.465-466)
Book-period gender indicators	FACT: Gauba uses development and empowerment indicators to show that gender justice includes health, education and power, not merely formal rights. (PDF pp.466-468)
Antonio Gramsci	FACT: Subaltern justice exposes hegemony, elite-centred history and exploitation masked as consent. (PDF pp.467-469)
MacIntyre / Sandel / Taylor / Walzer	FACT: Communitarian thinkers stress virtue, embeddedness, social context and sphere-specific meanings of goods against abstract liberal universalism. (PDF pp.470-473)

SESSION 5 - Illustrative Cases and Evidence Units

7. Illustrative examples

- FACT: Rawls's anti-utilitarian point is illustrated by the possibility that aggregate happiness could rise even while a minority is enslaved; he rejects such trade-offs. (PDF p.447)
- FACT: Nozick's Wilt Chamberlain example shows why voluntary exchange may generate inequality without, in his view, making the outcome unjust. (PDF p.451)
- FACT: Nozick's water-source example shows that initial acquisition is not unlimited; control over an indispensable natural resource cannot rightfully make others worse off. (PDF p.451)
- FACT: Marxist surplus-value analysis illustrates injustice when labour creates more value than the worker receives back as wages. (PDF pp.453-455)
- FACT: Feminist justice is illustrated through historically denied rights to women's education, property, vote and occupations, followed by claims for compensatory measures. (PDF pp.465-468)
- FACT: Subaltern justice is illustrated through the contrast between elite theory, which naturalizes rule, and Gramsci's view that hegemony makes subordination look consensual. (PDF pp.468-469)
- FACT: Walzer's example of keeping money from corrupting politics, health and education illustrates communitarian "complex equality." (PDF p.473)
- ANALYSIS: In answer writing, treat these as timeless conceptual illustrations or clearly historical book-period examples, not present-day statistics.

SESSION 6 - The Six-Axis Comparative Matrix

8. Comparison table

Semantic table split - Perspective

- **Perspective:** Rawlsian liberal
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Equal liberties first; the second principle then requires fair opportunity before inequalities can be tested by the difference principle (PDF p.448).
- **State:** FACT: Active state may pursue distributive justice and regulate inequalities. (PDF pp.448-450)
- **Property:** FACT: Retains capitalism conditionally, but only in a more humane, regulated form. (PDF p.450)
- **Equality:** FACT: Equal liberty plus justified inequality, not simple leveling. (PDF pp.448-449)
- **Community:** ANALYSIS: Gauba's "chain connection" is his explanatory presentation of social interdependence, not a substitute for Rawls's ordered principles.
- **Critique:** FACT: Criticized by collectivists, Marxists, libertarians and communitarians from different angles. (PDF pp.448-449)
- **Perspective:** Libertarian (Nozick)
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Historical entitlement through just acquisition, voluntary transfer and rectification. All three matter (PDF pp.450-452).
- **State:** FACT: Minimal protective state plus rectification, not patterned welfare redistribution. (PDF pp.451-452)
- **Property:** FACT: Strong private property and self-ownership are central to liberty, qualified by just title and the acquisition proviso.
- **Equality:** FACT: Equality of outcome is irrelevant only where holdings arose justly.
- **Community:** FACT: Community does not automatically ground coercive redistribution; voluntary aid remains possible.
- **Critique:** FACT: Criticized for underestimating structural injustice and the indeterminacy of rectification.
- **Perspective:** Marxist
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Ultimately distribution by need in communist society; under capitalism, justice cannot be reduced to fair shares inside an exploitative system. (PDF pp.453, 458-459)
- **State:** FACT: Socialist state is transitional, then expected to wither away with class abolition. (PDF pp.455-459)
- **Property:** FACT: Abolishes private ownership of major means of production while distinguishing personal property. (PDF pp.458-459)
- **Equality:** FACT: Seeks abolition of exploitative class inequality. (PDF pp.453-459)
- **Community:** FACT: Envisions classless association where free development of each supports all. (PDF pp.458-459)
- **Critique:** FACT: Criticized because new domination may reappear through political or bureaucratic power. (PDF p.459)
- **Perspective:** Democratic-socialist
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Social justice through partial socialization, welfare, public services and democratic rights. (PDF pp.459-461)
- **State:** FACT: Strong welfare-democratic state, but not dictatorship. (PDF pp.460-461)
- **Property:** FACT: Mixed regime: some essential sectors under state ownership, not wholesale abolition. (PDF p.459)
- **Equality:** FACT: Combines socio-economic justice with civil liberties and personality development. (PDF pp.459-460)
- **Community:** FACT: Public opinion, work culture and democratic institutions are needed to sustain it. (PDF p.461)
- **Critique:** FACT: Criticized as hard to fund and politically difficult to sustain without coercion or incentive loss. (PDF p.461)
- **Perspective:** Anarchist

- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Equitable sharing through voluntary cooperation, mutualism or communal association, not imposed hierarchy. (PDF pp.461-464)
- **State:** FACT: State is coercive evil to be abolished or progressively diluted. (PDF pp.461-464)
- **Property:** FACT: Often hostile to property as domination, though strands differ. (PDF pp.462-464)
- **Equality:** FACT: Equality means release from domination by state, hierarchy and exploitative ownership. (PDF pp.462-464)
- **Community:** FACT: Small associations, federations and mutual aid are preferred to centralized rule. (PDF pp.462-464)
- **Critique:** FACT: Criticized as politically impracticable, overly optimistic about human nature, and weak on regulation. (PDF p.464)
- **Perspective:** Feminist
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Justice requires equal rights plus corrective support against gendered disadvantage. (PDF pp.465-468)
- **State:** FACT: State may need to secure education, representation, reservations and protective benefits. (PDF pp.466-468)
- **Property:** FACT: Challenges women's historic exclusion from property ownership and economic power. (PDF pp.465-468)
- **Equality:** FACT: Equality includes effective status, empowerment, participation and share in power. (PDF pp.466-468)
- **Community:** FACT: Community arrangements are suspect when they naturalize patriarchal roles. (PDF pp.465-467)
- **Critique:** FACT: Critiques social arrangements that turn biological difference into unwarranted subordination. (PDF pp.465-468)
- **Perspective:** Subaltern
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Justice means restoring equitable shares, rights, dignity and protection to structurally subordinated groups. (PDF pp.467-469)
- **State:** FACT: State and history-writing must stop privileging elites and must protect marginalized groups. (PDF pp.468-469)
- **Property:** FACT: Property/class matters, but subordination extends beyond ownership into caste, culture, gender and hegemony. (PDF pp.467-469)
- **Equality:** FACT: Equality means ending undeserved subordination and rewarding contribution fairly. (PDF pp.468-469)
- **Community:** FACT: Community is divided by ruling-class hegemony unless subaltern agency can organize and speak. (PDF pp.467-469)
- **Critique:** FACT: Critiques elite theory for naturalizing rule and minimizing subordinate agency. (PDF pp.468-469)
- **Perspective:** Communitarian
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Distribution should reflect community meanings, virtue and sphere-specific reasons, not one abstract universal metric. (PDF pp.469-473)
- **State:** FACT: State is not neutral umpire alone; it may legitimately sustain common goods and proper boundaries between spheres. (PDF pp.470-473)
- **Property:** FACT: Property is not the sole key to social worth; money must not dominate every sphere. (PDF pp.472-473)
- **Equality:** FACT: Rejects simple equality; Walzer prefers complex equality across distinct social spheres. (PDF pp.472-473)
- **Community:** FACT: Persons are situated selves whose good is discovered through shared practices and deeper commonality. (PDF pp.470-472)
- **Critique:** FACT: Critiques liberal neutrality and the abstract or unencumbered self; is itself criticized for weak political mechanism. (PDF pp.469-473)

SESSION 7 - Trap Repair, Boundaries and PYQ Routes

9. UPSC traps and corrections

- WRONG: Rawls wants identical outcomes for all. -> FACT: Rawls permits inequality after liberty and fair opportunity, provided it benefits the least advantaged. (PDF p.448)
- WRONG: The difference principle alone is enough to justify an inequality. -> FACT: Equal basic liberties and fair equality of opportunity have lexical priority.
- WRONG: Nozick is anti-justice. -> FACT: Nozick proposes a full theory of justice, but one centred on entitlement rather than redistribution. (PDF pp.451-452)
- WRONG: Any voluntary market transfer is just for Nozick. -> FACT: The transfer must rest on just title; acquisition, transfer and rectification form a connected historical test.
- WRONG: Marxism has nothing to do with justice. -> FACT: Gauba says that would be too strong, because Marx condemns exploitation and endorses superior distributive principles in a classless order. (PDF p.453)
- WRONG: Democratic socialism is just Marxism without elections. -> FACT: It explicitly insists on freedom of thought, multi-party competition and opposition rights. (PDF pp.460-461)
- WRONG: Feminism only demands that women be treated exactly like men in every situation. -> FACT: Gauba also notes claims for maternity benefits and compensatory support rooted in actual disadvantage. (PDF pp.466-468)
- WRONG: Communitarian criticism means justice should give way to blind conformity. -> FACT: The criticism is directed at the abstract self and ethical neutrality, not at the very idea of justice. (PDF pp.469-473)

10. Cross-links and boundaries

- ANALYSIS: Read `Political-Theory/advanced/20_Diverse-Perspectives-on-Justice.md` for deeper criticism, Walzer's complex equality and thinker-by-thinker reconstruction.
- ANALYSIS: Conceptual prequel: `Political-Theory/basic/03_Liberalism-and-Neoliberalism.md` for liberal and libertarian background.
- ANALYSIS: Socialist and anarchist background:
`Political-Theory/basic/04_Marxism-and-Neo-Marxism.md` and
`Political-Theory/basic/05_Socialism-Fascism-Anarchism-and-Gandhism.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Gender and community background:
`Political-Theory/basic/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md` and
`Political-Theory/basic/07_Nature-of-Politics-and-Communitarianism.md`.
- ANALYSIS: State-role boundary:
`Political-Theory/basic/10_State-Civil-Society-Nation-and-Internationalism.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Module frame and topic map: `Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md` and
`Political-Theory/README.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Boundary: this file stays conceptual and does not duplicate constitutional reservations law, welfare statutes or court doctrine.
- ANALYSIS: Scope boundary: this canonical owner covers Gauba's eight chapter-framed perspectives. Capability and recognition are separately sourced extensions; multicultural, environmental/intergenerational, postcolonial and global justice remain external cross-routes unless independently sourced in their own owners.

Verified cross-applied Philosophy Optional PYQs

- FACT: **2019, 10 marks**: "How far do you think John Rawls is continuing with Plato's concept of justice?" Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.
- FACT: **2021, 10 marks**: "Discuss critically the distributive theory of justice as propounded by R. Nozick." Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.
- FACT: **2021, 20 marks**: "Discuss whether Amartya Sen's idea of justice is an improvement upon Rawl's theory of justice." Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.
- FACT: **2022, 15 marks**: "Explain the difference between the notion of equity and equality with reference to Marxian philosophy." Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

- FACT: **2023, 10 marks:** "What is meant by justice as fairness? Explain Rawls' theory of justice." Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.
- FACT: **2025, 20 marks:** "How are both equality and liberty inadequate as social and political ideals without justice? Discuss." Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

SESSION 8 - Revision Spine and Directive Control

11. Revision capsule / answer spine

- FACT: Rawls: two principles-equal basic liberties; then fair opportunity plus the difference principle in lexical order. Gauba presents the second principle's two parts as separate steps (PDF pp.447-450).
- FACT: Nozick: justice in holdings = acquisition + transfer + rectification under minimal state. (PDF pp.450-452)
- FACT: Marxist: injustice lies in exploitation and private ownership of major means of production; communist justice points to need-based distribution. (PDF pp.453-459)
- FACT: Democratic-socialist: welfare and social ownership must coexist with civil liberties and democratic competition. (PDF pp.459-461)
- FACT: Anarchist: justice seeks release from coercive authority and domination through voluntary association. (PDF pp.461-464)
- FACT: Feminist, subaltern and communitarian critiques widen justice beyond market shares to gendered power, structural subordination and embedded community meanings. (PDF pp.464-473)
- FACT: Walzer adds the important reminder that equality can mean keeping money from colonizing every other sphere of life. (PDF pp.472-473)
- ANALYSIS: One-line synthesis: Gauba's chapter moves from fair procedure, to valid title, to structural exploitation, structured subordination and finally to shared meanings of goods; recognition is a later analytical extension.
- ANALYSIS: Best answer move: compare each theory on rule of distribution, role of state, treatment of property, idea of equality, view of community, and strongest criticism.
- FACT: **Verified PYQ (2023):** What is justice as fairness? Explain Rawls's theory of justice.
- ANALYSIS: PYQ trap: do not write only the difference principle; define original position and veil of ignorance, state the two principles and their priority, then add objections.

12. Directive decoding and mark-scaled answer architecture

- ANALYSIS: **Directive decoding for this topic:**
- "Examine/Discuss Rawls's theory of justice" -> exposition of the two principles **plus** critical engagement; a pure summary loses marks.
- "Critically evaluate/analyse Nozick's entitlement theory" -> state the theory, then run at least one objection-reply chain before a verdict.
- "Is redistribution compatible with justice?" / "Can justice be defined without equality?" -> comparison-type directive; structure the answer around two or more rival theories, not one.
- "Justice as fairness" as a stem phrase -> signals Rawls specifically; do not drift into a generic justice essay.
- ANALYSIS: **10-mark architecture (~150 words):** one-line qualified thesis naming the theory/theories in play -> 2 supporting premises with one named evidence unit (veil of ignorance, or Wilt Chamberlain) -> one brief objection+reply -> one-line qualified conclusion.
- ANALYSIS: **15-mark architecture (~200-250 words):** qualified thesis -> comparison across two rival theories (e.g., Rawls vs Nozick, or liberal vs Marxist) -> two named evidence units -> one full objection-reply chain -> one cautious Indian illustration -> qualified conclusion naming the residual tension.
- ANALYSIS: **20-mark architecture (~250-300 words):** qualified thesis stated with its own limitation flagged upfront -> multi-dimensional comparison (distribution rule / role of state / property / community, drawn from Section 8) -> three named evidence units -> two objection-reply chains -> cautious Indian application -> optional capability/recognition extension if the question invites a wider lens -> graded conclusion that names what remains unresolved rather than declaring one theory simply "correct."

SESSION 9 - Argument Reconstruction and Objection-Reply Chains

13. Argument reconstruction (premises -> conclusion)

- ANALYSIS: **Rawls, reconstructed for answer-writing** (synthesis of FACT: PDF pp.447-450, not a direct quotation): P1: rational agents choose principles behind a veil of ignorance, unaware of their own place, talents or conception of the good. P2: under such uncertainty, risk-averse rational choice favours principles that protect the worst-off position (maximin reasoning) and refuses to gamble away basic liberty. P3: liberties, once secured, cannot be traded away for greater aggregate welfare. C: justice as fairness = equal basic liberties, then fair equality of opportunity, then the difference principle, held in strict lexical order.
- ANALYSIS: **Nozick, reconstructed** (synthesis of FACT: PDF pp.450-452): P1: individuals are self-owners bearing rights that act as side-constraints on how others, including the state, may treat them. P2: a distribution is just only if it has a just history - just acquisition, voluntary transfer, or rectification of a past injustice. P3: any "patterned" principle (such as the difference principle) requires continual interference with voluntary exchange to keep restoring the pattern, illustrated by the Wilt Chamberlain example (PDF p.451). C: justice is historical and entitlement-based, not end-state patterned; taxing legitimately acquired income to fund redistribution is, on Nozick's view, a rights violation.
- ANALYSIS: **Capability approach (Sen/Nussbaum), added as supplementary synthesis - not part of this file's Gauba grounding and not to be cited with a PDF page number**: P1: what matters morally is a person's real freedom to achieve valued functionings (beings and doings), not merely the resources or primary goods they hold. P2: people convert the same resources into capability unevenly because of disability, gender norms or social position. P3: therefore equal primary goods (Rawls) or equal formal titles (Nozick) can still coexist with unequal real freedom. C: justice should also be assessed through capability sets - use this only as a named extension for broader "diverse perspectives" questions, sourced to Sen's *Development as Freedom* (1999) and Nussbaum's capabilities list, not to Gauba's chapter.
- ANALYSIS: **Recognition (Fraser/Honneth), supplementary synthesis, not Gauba-grounded**: P1: injustice includes mis-recognition and status subordination (stigma, disrespect), not only maldistribution of goods. P2: redistribution alone cannot repair harms rooted in patterns of cultural valuation. C: justice requires "parity of participation" combining redistribution and recognition (Fraser's formulation) - cite as a named extension, useful for gender/caste-recognition questions, kept separate from the Gauba-sourced feminist/subaltern material already in Sections 4-8.
- ANALYSIS: **Postcolonial and global justice route**: this file does not canonically own a postcolonial/decolonial or global-justice module. When a question explicitly requires those dimensions, route to `Political-Theory/basic/19_Justice-Concepts-and-Dimensions.md` and to separately sourced postcolonial material rather than attaching unnamed claims to this owner.

14. Objection-reply chains (minimum two, for direct reuse in answers)

1. **Communitarian objection to Rawls (Sandel) -> Rawlsian reply**: Objection - the "unencumbered self" imagined behind the veil of ignorance is impossible; real persons are partly constituted by ends, roles and attachments they cannot simply bracket. Reply - the veil is a heuristic device for choosing fair principles of the basic structure, not a metaphysical claim about actual selves; a "thin" theory of the good suffices to generate principles, after which thick community life proceeds within just constraints.
2. **Libertarian objection to Rawls (Nozick) -> Rawlsian reply**: Objection - the difference principle treats natural talents as a collective asset and requires continual redistribution, violating self-ownership (Wilt Chamberlain example). Reply - Rawlsian principles govern background institutions and the basic structure, not every individual transaction; redistributive taxation is a structural rule chosen ex ante behind the veil, not an ad hoc seizure of one transfer.
3. **Egalitarian/Marxist objection to Nozick -> Nozickian reply**: Objection - historical entitlement ignores whether the starting distribution of talent and inherited wealth is itself morally arbitrary, so "just acquisition" can launder pre-existing inequality. Reply - the Lockean acquisition proviso and the rectification principle already target illegitimate original acquisition; residual natural inequality of talent does not itself violate anyone's rights unless it actively worsens others' position.

4. **Feminist/subaltern objection to formal-equality frameworks -> liberal reply:** Objection - equal basic liberties or equal formal titles ignore gendered and caste-based structural disadvantage in the real capacity to exercise those liberties. Reply - Gauba's own account already shows feminist justice pressing for compensatory measures such as maternity benefit and reservation precisely to convert formal into substantive equality (PDF pp.466-468); this shows liberal frameworks can be supplemented rather than simply discarded.

SESSION 10 - Indian Applications, Quotation Safety and MCQ Ledger

15. Cautious Indian application (ANALYSIS: throughout - analytical bridges, not Gauba-sourced)

- ANALYSIS: Reservations in public employment and education (a widely known constitutional mechanism) can be read through Rawls's fair equality of opportunity and difference principle as compensatory opportunity for structurally disadvantaged groups, while the Nozickian entitlement worry about merit and title supplies the standard counter-argument. Constitutional article numbers and case law belong to the Polity/Law files; this file supplies only the political-theory lens.
- ANALYSIS: The shift of the right to property from a fundamental right to a legal right (a well-known constitutional change enacted through the 44th Amendment, 1978) can be used as an illustrative Indian parallel to the broader liberal-versus-welfare-state tension; state this only as an analytical bridge, not as Gauba-sourced content.
- ANALYSIS: Welfare and employment-guarantee schemes illustrate the welfare-liberal/democratic-socialist correction of market distribution rather than a Nozickian minimal-state approach; use only as a conceptual illustration, without asserting specific scheme data that is not independently verified.
- ANALYSIS: All Indian illustrations in this section are exam-use analytical bridges. They must not be cited with a Gauba PDF page number.

16. Quotation and proposition handling

- ANALYSIS: Do not invent exact wording for Rawls's or Nozick's arguments beyond the standard technical terms already used in this file. Prefer paraphrase-as-proposition ("Rawls argues that...", "Nozick holds that...") over invented direct quotations.
- ANALYSIS: Safe technical terms that may be used as quoted nomenclature because they are standard vocabulary, not disputed quotations: "veil of ignorance", "original position", "difference principle", "self-ownership", "entitlement theory", "trusteeship", "sarvodaya" (cross-reference), "complex equality" (Walzer).
- ANALYSIS: If a question asks to engage "in the scholar's own words," write "as Rawls's/Nozick's position is commonly summarised, ..." rather than presenting an invented quotation with a page number that cannot be verified against this file's source window.

17. Sources, metadata and tags

- FACT: Primary source used directly: Gauba, Ch.20, PDF pp.446-473.
- FACT: Rawls anchor pages: PDF pp.447-450.
- FACT: Nozick anchor pages: PDF pp.450-452.
- FACT: Marxist, democratic-socialist and anarchist anchor pages: PDF pp.452-464.
- FACT: Feminist, subaltern and communitarian anchor pages: PDF pp.464-473.
- FACT: Walzer and communitarian critique anchor pages: PDF pp.470-473.
- FACT: Chapter-opening perspective list anchor: PDF p.446.
- FACT: Verified local PYQ: Philosophy/paper-2/_PYQ-SocioPolitical-2018-2025.md.
- ANALYSIS: No post-2009 example has been introduced; all illustrations remain conceptual or clearly book-period.
- ANALYSIS: The matrix format and some comparative wording are exam-oriented syntheses built from Gauba's chapter structure and are tagged accordingly.
- ANALYSIS: Sections 12-16 (added in this pass) are exam-answer-architecture and supplementary-theory syntheses. Capability and recognition are explicitly not claimed as part of Gauba's Fifth Edition (2009) Ch.20 and are sourced only to the named scholars identified inline. Postcolonial and global justice are routed out rather than treated as owned content.

18. Canonical MCQ concept ledger

- FACT: **Primary goods:** Rawls's distributive object includes rights, liberties, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- FACT: **Original position:** a hypothetical fair-choice situation in which principles are selected without existing bargaining advantages.
- FACT: **Veil of ignorance:** the parties do not know their class, talents, status or particular conception of the good.
- FACT: **Equal basic liberties:** Rawls's first principle protects an equal scheme of compatible basic liberties.
- FACT: **Fair equality of opportunity:** offices must be genuinely accessible, not merely open in formal law.
- FACT: **Difference principle:** inequality is permitted only after prior principles are met and when it benefits the least advantaged.
- FACT: **Entitlement theory:** Nozick tests holdings through just acquisition, voluntary transfer and rectification.
- FACT: **Self-ownership:** persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- FACT: **Minimal protective state:** legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- FACT: **Wilt Chamberlain example:** repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.
- FACT: **Water-source example:** appropriation of an indispensable resource shows that initial acquisition is not morally unlimited.
- FACT: **Rectification principle:** injustice in acquisition or transfer must be corrected before present holdings can count as entitled.
- FACT: **Surplus value:** labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- FACT: **Democratic socialism:** welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- FACT: **Voluntary cooperation:** anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- FACT: **Feminist corrective equality:** identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.
- FACT: **Subaltern justice:** justice must protect the dignity, agency and fair reward of structurally subordinated groups.
- FACT: **Hegemony:** domination persists partly by making elite interests and unequal arrangements appear natural or consensual.
- FACT: **Situated / embedded self:** communitarian personhood is formed through roles, practices, traditions and shared ends.
- FACT: **Complex equality:** one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- ANALYSIS: **Chain connection:** Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.
- ANALYSIS: **Capability approach:** Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- ANALYSIS: **Parity of participation:** Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.
- ANALYSIS: **Mis-recognition:** status subordination or public devaluation can remain unjust even when some material redistribution occurs.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

A scholarship board compares citizens' access to liberties, offices, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect. Which account identifies the relevant bundle?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- C. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- D. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Primary goods** with **Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

A court asks what citizens receive in liberties, opportunities and means. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- B. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- C. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- D. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Primary goods** with **Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Constitution-designers must select principles before knowing which social position they will occupy. Which account identifies the choice situation itself?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Original position** with **Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Constitution-makers are modelled before bargaining power is known. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- C. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.
- D. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Original position** with **Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Negotiators know general social facts but are denied knowledge of their own class, talents and rank. Which account identifies this informational restriction?

- A. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- B. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Veil of ignorance** with **The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

A rule is made without knowing one's future status. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Veil of ignorance** with **The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

A government proposes suppressing political criticism because the resulting stability would finance larger transfers. Which account rules out this bargain?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- C. Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty.
- D. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Equal basic liberties** with **Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

A welfare plan curbs free speech to aid the poor. Which account applies most directly?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- C. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- D. Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Equal basic liberties** with **Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Public posts are legally open to all, yet inherited schooling advantages determine who can compete effectively. Which account diagnoses the remaining injustice?

- A. Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality.
- B. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Fair equality of opportunity** with **Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Elite schooling makes office legal but unreal for most citizens. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Fair equality of opportunity** with **Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

A pay differential is defended only after showing that it improves the position of those worst placed. Which source-grounded account tests the claim?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- C. Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged.
- D. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Difference principle** with **Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Higher rewards are allowed because the worst-off become better off. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- C. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- D. Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Difference principle** with **Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

An auditor refuses to compare final shares and instead traces how every holding was acquired, transferred and corrected. Which account guides the inquiry?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- C. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- D. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Entitlement theory** with **Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

A claimant rejects end-state equality and reconstructs title history. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- B. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- C. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- D. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Entitlement theory** with **Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

A policy treats a person's body and talents as resources available for compulsory social use. Which account supplies the objection?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- C. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- D. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Self-ownership** with **persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Taxation is attacked as using one person's talents for another. Which account applies most directly?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- C. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.
- D. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Self-ownership** with **persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

A constitution confines government to policing force and fraud, enforcing contracts and correcting proven wrongs. Which account best explains the limit?

- A. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- B. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- C. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- D. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Minimal protective state** with **legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Government polices and adjudicates but refuses patterned welfare design. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- C. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- D. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Minimal protective state** with **legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

An initially equal distribution changes because thousands voluntarily pay to watch one athlete. Which account explains why the new pattern matters?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- C. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.
- D. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Wilt Chamberlain example** with **repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Many fans pay one player and inequality grows through choice. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- C. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- D. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Wilt Chamberlain example** with **repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

One owner acquires the only dependable water supply and can now dictate terms to an entire settlement. Which account exposes the limit on acquisition?

- A. appropriation of an indispensable resource shows that initial acquisition is not morally unlimited.
- B. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- C. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- D. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Water-source example** with **appropriation of an indispensable resource shows that initial acquisition is not morally unlimited**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Someone controls the only water source and subjects all to private discretion. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. appropriation of an indispensable resource shows that initial acquisition is not morally unlimited.
- C. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- D. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Water-source example** with **appropriation of an indispensable resource shows that initial acquisition is not morally unlimited**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

A present possessor bought land lawfully, but the chain begins in forced dispossession. Which account prevents the latest transfer from settling justice?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- C. injustice in acquisition or transfer must be corrected before present holdings can count as entitled.
- D. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Rectification principle** with **injustice in acquisition or transfer must be corrected before present holdings can count as entitled**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

A recent sale is valid, but the asset began in dispossession. Which account applies most directly?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- C. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- D. injustice in acquisition or transfer must be corrected before present holdings can count as entitled.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Rectification principle** with **injustice in acquisition or transfer must be corrected before present holdings can count as entitled**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

A factory's workforce produces output worth more than wages and operating replacement, while owners retain the remainder. Which account diagnoses the relation?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- C. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- D. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Surplus value** with **labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Ownership captures unpaid labour time through production. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- B. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- C. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- D. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Surplus value** with **labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

A movement combines social ownership and universal welfare with civil liberties, multiparty competition and accountable government. Which account fits?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- C. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- D. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Democratic socialism** with **welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Public services expand while dictatorship is rejected. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- C. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.
- D. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Democratic socialism** with **welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Local associations coordinate mutual aid through federation and consent rather than a coercive central hierarchy. Which account best explains the ideal?

- A. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- B. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- C. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- D. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Voluntary cooperation** with **anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Small federated groups reject coercive central rule. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- C. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- D. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Voluntary cooperation** with **anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

A formally neutral care policy leaves one gender carrying unpaid burdens that block property, office and voice. Which account reveals why sameness is insufficient?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- C. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.
- D. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Feminist corrective equality** with **identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

A neutral rule leaves women excluded from property and power. Which account applies most directly?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- C. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- D. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Feminist corrective equality** with **identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

A community performs indispensable labour yet remains absent from elite histories, public honour and decision-making. Which account identifies the injustice?

- A. justice must protect the dignity, agency and fair reward of structurally subordinated groups.
- B. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- C. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- D. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Subaltern justice** with **justice must protect the dignity, agency and fair reward of structurally subordinated groups**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Groups produce social wealth yet remain marginal under elite narratives. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. justice must protect the dignity, agency and fair reward of structurally subordinated groups.
- C. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- D. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Subaltern justice** with **justice must protect the dignity, agency and fair reward of structurally subordinated groups**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

A hierarchy survives partly because schools, media and everyday language present it as natural common sense. Which account explains that durability?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- C. domination persists partly by making elite interests and unequal arrangements appear natural or consensual.
- D. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hegemony** with **domination persists partly by making elite interests and unequal arrangements appear natural or consensual**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Public culture makes subordination seem like common sense. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- C. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- D. domination persists partly by making elite interests and unequal arrangements appear natural or consensual.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hegemony** with **domination persists partly by making elite interests and unequal arrangements appear natural or consensual**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

A political argument begins with identities formed through language, membership and shared practices rather than an isolated chooser. Which account fits?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- C. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- D. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Situated / embedded self** with **Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

A theory rejects the isolated chooser and starts from shared practices. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- B. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- C. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- D. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Situated / embedded self** with **Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

A wealthy citizen tries to convert money into public office, educational rank and medical priority. Which account rejects that cross-sphere dominance?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- C. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- D. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Complex equality** with **one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Wealth cannot buy office or educational rank across unlike goods. Which account applies most directly?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- C. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.
- D. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Complex equality** with **one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

An answer defends a limited inequality by tracing how socially connected gains reach those at the weakest link. Which account identifies this explanatory device?

- A. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.
- B. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Chain connection** with **Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

An answer explains Rawls through social interdependence, not a separate principle. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Chain connection** with **Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Two people receive identical resources, but disability and social barriers leave only one able to convert them into mobility and work. Which account best diagnoses the gap?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- C. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- D. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Capability approach** with **Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Two citizens get the same support, but only one converts it into real freedom. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- C. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.
- D. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Capability approach** with **Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

A group receives redistribution but remains excluded from agenda-setting and equal standing in public debate. Which account states the missing standard?

- A. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.
- B. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- C. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- D. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Parity of participation** with **Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

A group gets funds but lacks equal standing in decisions. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.
- C. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- D. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Parity of participation** with **Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Material support rises while public stigma, humiliation and status subordination remain unchanged. Which account identifies the surviving wrong?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- C. status subordination or public devaluation can remain unjust even when some material redistribution occurs.
- D. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mis-recognition** with **status subordination or public devaluation can remain unjust even when some material redistribution occurs**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Funds arrive, but the group remains publicly dishonoured and unheard. Which account applies most directly?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- C. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- D. status subordination or public devaluation can remain unjust even when some material redistribution occurs.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mis-recognition** with **status subordination or public devaluation can remain unjust even when some material redistribution occurs**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Cross-application ownership note: These are verified Philosophy Optional questions whose primary owner is Social and Political Ideals. They are not re-routed to Political Theory; they are included because this topic provides a directly usable supporting framework.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2019 Q1(a), 10 marks

Question: How far do you think John Rawls is continuing with Plato's concept of justice?

Model solution

Thesis. Rawls continues Plato only in a broad architectonic sense -- justice as the virtue that structures a well-ordered whole -- and breaks with him radically on method, citizenship and equality. State the criterion of "continuity" first.

- **Continuity.** For Plato, justice is right-order: each part of soul and city performs its own function in harmony. For Rawls, justice is the first virtue of the basic structure -- fair terms of cooperation among free and equal persons. Both make justice the ORDERING virtue of the social whole, not one desire among others.

- **Break 1 -- method.** Plato reaches justice through the metaphysics of the Forms and functional differentiation; Rawls through a hypothetical device, the original position under a veil of ignorance -- a device of representation, not a cosmology.

- **Break 2 -- equality and citizenship.** Plato's order is a fixed hierarchy of natural kinds; Rawls builds in equal basic liberties and fair equality of opportunity for equal citizens, explicitly rejecting caste-like closure.

Verdict. The continuity is thin (justice as the structure of a good society); the discontinuity is deep (democratic-egalitarian method against fixed hierarchy). Rawls inherits Plato's QUESTION, not his ANSWER.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it names the axis of continuity before judging, and separates a shared question from opposed answers instead of forcing a single verdict.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2021 Q1(a), 10 marks

Question: Discuss critically the distributive theory of justice as propounded by R. Nozick.

Model solution

Thesis. Nozick's is a HISTORICAL (entitlement) theory, not a distributive one in the patterned sense: a distribution is just if it arose through just steps, whatever its final shape. Powerful as a warning, it is incomplete on its own premises.

- **Doctrine.** Justice in holdings has three principles -- justice in ACQUISITION

(how unowned things are first justly held), justice in TRANSFER (voluntary exchange and gift) and justice in RECTIFICATION (correcting past injustice). There is no required end-state pattern.

- **Historical vs patterned.** Patterned principles (equality, need, merit) judge

the shape of the distribution; historical principles judge the PROCESS. The Wilt Chamberlain argument shows that if people freely pay to watch him, the resulting inequality is just, and maintaining any fixed pattern would require continuous interference with voluntary transfers.

- **Critique.** The acquisition and rectification principles are the weakest

links: both need an independent criterion, and real starting distributions are tainted by conquest, coercion and background injustice, so "voluntariness" is rarely clean.

Verdict. Nozick's side-constraint, self-ownership warning against overreaching redistribution is a permanent contribution; but because his own foundational principles are under-specified, entitlement theory cannot bypass the problem of unjust starting points.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it fixes the historical/patterned distinction, uses Wilt Chamberlain as argument (not decoration), and lands the critique on acquisition/rectification.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2021 Q2(a), 20 marks

Question: Discuss whether Amartya Sen's idea of justice is an improvement upon Rawl's theory of justice.

Model solution

Thesis. Whether Sen improves on Rawls is CRITERION-RELATIVE: judged by attention to realised freedom and remediable injustice Sen improves on Rawls; judged by the need for determinate institutional principles Rawls retains the advantage. Name the test before applying it.

- **Rawls in brief.** A just basic structure chosen behind the veil of ignorance:

equal basic liberties, fair equality of opportunity and the difference principle. Its focus is ideal, transcendental and institution-centred.

- **Sen's reorientation.** Sen contrasts NITI (correctness of rules and institutions) with NYAYA (justice realised in actual lives). A society may have fine rules yet produce grave injustice, so we should COMPARE feasible social states and remove manifest injustice rather than seek one perfectly just structure; the metric is CAPABILITIES, refined through PUBLIC REASONING.

- **The improvement, assessed.** By the criterion of realised freedom, Sen improves on Rawls -- primary goods ignore the diversity of conversion into real freedom, and transcendental design can neglect how people actually fare. But by the criterion of institutional determinacy, comparative ranking without an ideal benchmark can under-determine choice among rival improvements.

- **Rawlsian reply.** Institutions remain indispensable preconditions of justice; comparison still presupposes standards the ideal theory helps supply.

Verdict. Sen improves on Rawls in ORIENTATION (from arrangements to lives, from resources to capabilities), but does not simply supersede him; "improvement" holds only on a stated criterion, and both are needed.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it states the criterion of improvement first, uses niti/nyaya and capabilities as argument, concedes what Rawls still does better, and gives a criterion-relative verdict.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2022 Q2(c), 15 marks

Question: Explain the difference between the notion of equity and equality with reference to Marxian philosophy.

Model solution

Thesis. In Marxian philosophy, EQUALITY is the application of one common measure to all, while EQUITY is differentiated distribution responsive to real need; Marx's deeper claim is that formal equal right can be a right of INEQUALITY.

- **The distinction.** Equality = same standard for everyone (equivalent exchange among legal equals). Equity = shares differentiated by need and actual condition ("to each according to his need"). Equal treatment of unequally-placed people reproduces disadvantage.
- **Marx's argument.** Bourgeois equality abstracts from class structure. The wage contract LOOKS free and equal, but a right measured by a common standard is applied to people who differ in need, burden and family condition -- so equal right is, in content, a right of inequality; and the wage relation itself is structurally exploitative.
- **The two-stage caution.** The need-principle belongs to a HIGHER stage of cooperation where alienated labour and scarcity are transformed; it is not a market-time salary rule, and reading it as one invites the "vague / weakens incentive" objection.

Verdict. Equality and equity diverge because a single measure cannot be fair to unequal needs; Marx uses the distinction to expose the class content hidden beneath formally equal exchange.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it fixes the measure-vs-need distinction, roots it in the equal-right-as-right-of-inequality argument, and flags the higher-stage qualification without drifting into a Political-Ideologies essay.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2023 Q1(a), 10 marks

Question: What is meant by justice as fairness? Explain Rawls' theory of justice.

Model solution

Thesis. "Justice as fairness" means that the principles of justice are those that free and equal persons would choose under fair conditions; Rawls builds those conditions into the original position and derives two lexically ordered principles.

- **The device.** In the ORIGINAL POSITION, parties choose principles for the basic structure behind a VEIL OF IGNORANCE -- not knowing their class, sex, talents, religion or conception of the good. Ignorance of arbitrary advantage makes the choice fair; it is a device of representation, not a historical contract.

- **The two principles.** (1) Each has an equal claim to a fully adequate scheme of equal BASIC LIBERTIES. (2) Social and economic inequalities must satisfy (a) FAIR equality of opportunity and (b) the DIFFERENCE PRINCIPLE -- they may stand only if they benefit the LEAST ADVANTAGED.

- **Priority and justification.** Liberty is LEXICALLY prior (never traded for economic gain); fair opportunity precedes the difference principle. Justification proceeds by REFLECTIVE EQUILIBRIUM -- mutual adjustment of principles and considered judgments.

Verdict. Justice as fairness is a deontological liberal egalitarianism: liberty is basic, and inequality is tolerated only under fair opportunity and benefit to the least advantaged.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it defines fairness through the fair choice situation, states the principles with their PRIORITY, and adds reflective equilibrium rather than listing slogans.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2025 Q4(a), 20 marks

Question: How are both equality and liberty inadequate as social and political ideals without justice? Discuss.

Model solution

Thesis. Equality and liberty are indispensable but INADEQUATE by themselves, because each is indeterminate about its own content; justice is the architectonic ideal that supplies the ordering criteria and decides their scope and priority.

- **Why liberty alone is inadequate.** "Liberty" does not tell us WHICH liberties are basic, or how to weigh one person's freedom against another's. A tyrant and a citizen both invoke freedom; negative, positive and republican conceptions pull apart. Only a theory of justice ranks basic liberties and protects them (Rawls's lexical priority).

- **Why equality alone is inadequate.** "Equality" is under-specified -- of status, rights, opportunity, welfare, resources, capability or outcome? Each metric yields different institutions, and without a criterion, equality collapses into either mechanical levelling or empty formalism.

- **What justice supplies.** Justice provides the adjudicatory criteria -- desert, fairness, entitlement, need, capability, rectification and public reason -- that say which inequalities are justified and which liberties are basic. Compare the positions: liberty-first (Nozick) protects self-ownership but lets background injustice hollow real freedom; equality-first levelling flags oppression but flattens choice and desert; justice-as-ordering balances them by principle.

- **Indian anchor.** Ambedkar: political democracy (equal votes, formal liberty) is unstable without SOCIAL democracy -- liberty, equality AND fraternity -- so justice must reach lived social standing, not only procedure.

Verdict. Liberty and equality are the substance of a just society, but justice is its FORM: it is the ideal that disciplines and coordinates the other two, and without it each remains normatively incomplete.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it proves inadequacy by showing each ideal is indeterminate about its own content, compares three ordering positions, anchors in Ambedkar, and ends with the architectonic verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish Rawls's difference principle from Nozick's entitlement theory. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Rawls's difference principle and Nozick's entitlement theory answer inequality through rival moral tests. Rawls judges institutions by fairness to the least advantaged, while Nozick judges holdings by their history.

Core analysis: For Rawls, equal basic liberties come first, fair equality of opportunity comes next, and only then may inequalities stand if they improve the position of the least advantaged. Nozick rejects such patterned assessment. He asks whether holdings arose through just acquisition, voluntary transfer and rectification of past injustice under a minimal protective state. Rawls therefore evaluates the basic structure prospectively; Nozick evaluates titles historically.

Critical evaluation: Each theory exposes the other's blind spot. Rawls risks underplaying title and incentive, while Nozick leaves structural inequality and rectification seriously under-specified.

Conclusion: Rawls and Nozick disagree not merely over equality but over what makes a holding just: fair institutions ordered to the least advantaged versus historically valid title constrained by rectification.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why is Walzer's complex equality not simple levelling? Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Walzer's complex equality is not a call for identical shares of every good. It is a doctrine about protecting distinct social spheres from illegitimate conversion by money or power.

Core analysis: Different goods carry different social meanings and should be distributed for different reasons. Political office should not be bought like a commodity, education should not simply follow wealth, and health care should not be reduced to market purchasing power. Simple equality would try to flatten all holdings by one metric. Walzer's alternative is to prevent dominance: advantage in one sphere must not automatically command superiority in another.

Critical evaluation: The view is morally sharp but institutionally thinner than Rawls or Nozick. It explains what should not dominate, yet says less about the precise machinery that secures those boundaries.

Conclusion: Walzer's point is not that every sphere must yield identical shares, but that money or power must not buy dominance across unlike goods with distinct social meanings.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Compare feminist and subaltern critiques of distributive justice. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Feminist and subaltern critiques challenge justice theories that examine only formal rules or market shares. Both argue that persons enter institutions already marked by hierarchy.

Core analysis: Feminist justice shows that equal treatment is inadequate where gendered burdens structure education, property, representation and bodily security. Gauba's own account allows corrective support, not mere identical treatment. Subaltern justice shifts attention to groups whose labour and contribution are undervalued because elite rule and hegemonic narratives make subordination appear natural or consensual. Both critiques therefore widen justice beyond contract and exchange toward power, dignity and voice.

Further development: The comparison becomes stronger when it asks what each critique adds to distributive theory. Feminist justice highlights the gap between formal rights and effective participation inside household and workplace relations. Subaltern justice highlights how representation and public meaning are monopolised before distribution is even counted. Together they show that status injury and under-valuation can precede and reinforce maldistribution.

Critical evaluation: Yet they should not be collapsed. Feminist analysis begins from patriarchy and gendered exclusion, whereas subaltern analysis centres structurally marginal agency, hegemony and elite-centred history.

Conclusion: Feminist and subaltern critiques deepen distributive justice by showing that formally neutral rules can preserve hierarchy unless power, voice and status injury are made part of the analysis.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Does Sen improve Rawls, or mainly change the metric of justice? Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Sen's intervention is best read as a reorientation of justice rather than a simple rejection of Rawls. He asks how far institutions enlarge actual capabilities in lived conditions.

Core analysis: Rawls distributes primary goods through principles chosen in the original position for a fair basic structure. Sen argues that equal resources or primary goods can still leave persons unequally free because disability, gendered burdens and social location affect conversion into real functionings. He therefore shifts attention from ideal design to comparative judgment, remediable injustice and public reasoning about what people are actually able to be and do. The metric changes from goods held to freedoms realised.

Further development: The key issue is the criterion of improvement. If justice is judged by real freedom and removal of manifest injustice, Sen clearly advances beyond Rawlsian primary goods. If justice also requires a stable ordering of institutions, liberties and offices, Sen supplements rather than supersedes Rawls. A good answer therefore separates metric, method and institutional determinacy before giving its verdict.

Critical evaluation: Rawls nevertheless retains an advantage in institutional specification. Sen improves the informational space of justice, but deliberately under-specifies a final set of principles for a fully just basic structure.

Conclusion: Sen improves Rawls most clearly by shifting justice from the distribution of primary goods to the comparison of real freedoms, yet he supplements rather than abolishes the need for institutional principles.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Can justice be exhausted by redistribution? Discuss with Rawls, Fraser and Ambedkarian/subaltern implications. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: A purely redistributive account captures only one family of injustice. The justice debate widens once unequal status and exclusion from rule-making are recognised as independent political wrongs.

Core analysis: Rawls remains indispensable because he shows why liberties, opportunity and the position of the least advantaged matter to institutional fairness. Yet redistribution alone cannot explain cases where a group remains stigmatised, unheard or publicly devalued even after material transfers occur. Fraser's parity-of-participation bridge therefore adds recognition and representation to distribution. Ambedkarian and subaltern implications, kept as cross-routes rather than proxy ownership, reinforce the point: graded status, hegemony and monopolised voice cannot be repaired by income measures alone.

Further development: The temporal and democratic dimensions sharpen the argument further. Recognition without representation lets elites speak for the injured, while redistribution without recognition may leave the public meaning of inferiority untouched. At the forward boundary, debates on democratisation, democratic backsliding and social movements belong to Topic 23; Topic 20 should only supply the justice standards later used to judge those processes.

Critical evaluation: Once justice expands beyond redistribution, new problems arise. Duty-bearers must be specified, remedies must remain reviewable, and not every status injury warrants the same institutional response. Otherwise the cure can become paternal or rhetorically expansive without administrative discipline.

Conclusion: Justice cannot be exhausted by redistribution because status subordination and exclusion from rule-making persist even when transfers occur; a defensible answer therefore joins resources, recognition and representation.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Evaluate whether democratic socialism is the strongest correction to both libertarianism and Marxist centralism. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Democratic socialism presents itself as a middle route between libertarian minimalism and Marxist centralism. It keeps social justice as a public aim while rejecting dictatorship and unregulated market title.

Core analysis: Against libertarianism, democratic socialism argues that formal liberty without welfare, public services and fair life-chances entrenches privilege. Against Marxist centralism, it argues that social ownership or regulation must coexist with freedom of thought, party competition, opposition rights and civil liberties. Gauba's account treats it as a constitutional and welfare-oriented correction: partial socialisation, public services and democratic procedure rather than revolutionary monopoly power.

Further development: The decisive test is democratic durability. Democratic socialism must fund welfare without administrative arbitrariness, protect labour without silencing opposition, and widen equality without concentrating unreviewable power. Where later questions shift to democratisation, backsliding or movement politics, Topic 23 should own the bridge; Topic 20 should stop at the justice-based criteria by which such regimes are judged. It must also balance welfare delivery with secure opposition rights and contestable public power.

Critical evaluation: The position still faces two serious objections. Libertarians question its treatment of title, incentives and state reach, while Marxists question whether capitalism can be humanised without leaving structural domination intact. Its success therefore depends less on slogan than on institutional design.

Conclusion: Democratic socialism is strongest when it corrects market privilege and Marxist authoritarian risk together, but it remains convincing only if welfare, liberty and democratic accountability are kept institutionally connected.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Political Theory | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS/Optional relevance:** GS-II (Polity & Governance) conceptual foundation; PSIR Optional Paper-1 background. **Core area:** Advanced comparison of distributive justice across liberal, libertarian, Marxist, democratic-socialist, anarchist, feminist, subaltern and communitarian traditions. **Grounded in:** O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.20, PDF pp.446-473. **Source edition/cutoff:** Fifth Edition (2009); no post-2009 fact is assumed unless independently dated and tagged **CURRENT:**. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference/synthesis | **CURRENT:** = dated current anchor | **WRONG:** = trap/misattribution. *Companion:* Political-Theory/basic/20_Diverse-Perspectives-on-Justice.md.

1. One-screen advanced map

- **FACT:** Gauba structures the chapter as a deliberate movement from liberal fairness, to libertarian entitlement, to socialist and anti-state critiques, and finally to feminist, subaltern and communitarian enlargements of justice. (PDF pp.446-473)
- **FACT:** Rawls tries to moralize distribution without abandoning liberal freedom. (PDF pp.446-450)
- **FACT:** Nozick historicizes holdings and moralizes property against welfare redistribution. (PDF pp.450-452)
- **FACT:** Marxism relocates injustice from pattern of shares to capitalist exploitation and class power. (PDF pp.452-459)
- **FACT:** Democratic socialism retains social justice but refuses dictatorship and insists on democratic freedoms. (PDF pp.459-461)
- **FACT:** Anarchism radicalizes anti-domination by treating coercive authority as itself the generator of injustice. (PDF pp.461-464)
- **FACT:** Feminist and subaltern perspectives expose how formally equal systems can still encode structured subordination. (PDF pp.464-469)
- **FACT:** Communitarianism attacks the abstract self and asks whether justice can be intelligible apart from historically situated communities and shared goods. (PDF pp.469-473)
- **ANALYSIS:** Advanced takeaway: the dispute is not merely about "who gets more," but about what counts as a person, a wrong, a good, and a legitimate site of distribution.

2. Scope, assumptions and conceptual boundary

- **FACT:** The chapter is about rival perspectives on justice, not a single authorial doctrine that settles them. (PDF p.446)
- **FACT:** Gauba's discussion of Rawls and Nozick belongs to late-20th-century Anglo-American debate, while Marxist, anarchist, feminist, subaltern and communitarian discussions widen the normative frame. (PDF pp.447-473)
- **ANALYSIS:** Gauba's chapter directly supplies distributive and anti-domination concerns; recognition is a later analytical bridge and must not be presented as his terminology.
- **ANALYSIS:** The chapter therefore has a widening logic: from fair shares, to title, to exploitation, to gender, to hegemony, to embedded community.
- **ANALYSIS:** Boundary: examples involving USSR, China, East Europe, UN reports and development rankings are book-period illustrations and cannot be silently updated into current evidence.
- **ANALYSIS:** Boundary: communitarian critique of abstract selves must not be turned into endorsement of authoritarian homogenization.

3. Direct-book argument reconstruction

- FACT: Gauba begins by saying modern political theory is deeply tied to the problem of justice and immediately lists eight major perspectives. (PDF p.446)
- FACT: He first presents Rawls because liberal justice tries to preserve liberty while accommodating equality and fraternity through a procedural device. (PDF pp.446-450)
- FACT: Rawls's method abstracts agents from social location through the original position and veil of ignorance so that chosen principles are fair to the least advantaged. (PDF pp.447-448)
- FACT: Gauba then turns to Nozick, who rejects patterned distribution and asks instead how specific persons came to hold specific goods. (PDF pp.450-452)
- FACT: The Marxist section shifts the terrain: if capitalist production rests on surplus extraction, then "fairer distribution" within capitalism may merely soften, not remove, injustice. (PDF pp.452-459)
- FACT: Democratic socialism revises Marxism by preferring evolutionary change, limited socialization and the coexistence of socio-economic justice with liberal freedoms. (PDF pp.459-461)
- FACT: Anarchism presses further by claiming the coercive state itself corrupts natural sociability and blocks just voluntary association. (PDF pp.461-464)
- FACT: Feminism and subaltern theory then insist that justice must see systematic subordination-gendered, classed, caste-like, cultural and hegemonic-not just contractual exchange. (PDF pp.464-469)
- FACT: Communitarianism closes the chapter by attacking liberal neutrality, the isolated self and one-size-fits-all distribution, and by recovering embedded selves, shared traditions and sphere-specific meanings of goods. (PDF pp.469-473)

4. Definitions and distinctions

Distinction	Advanced note
Procedural fairness / historical entitlement	FACT: Rawls justifies outcomes through fair choice of principles, whereas Nozick justifies holdings through their actual path of acquisition and transfer. (PDF pp.447-452)
Substantive liberty / formal liberty	FACT: Gauba presents liberal-Rawlsian justice as concerned with substantive liberty, but libertarian justice as focused on formal liberty and limited state. (PDF pp.446, 450)
Patterned distribution / anti-patterned distribution	ANALYSIS: This is the cleanest advanced shorthand for Rawls-versus-Nozick, though Gauba himself explains it through distribution rules versus modes of acquisition. (PDF pp.447-452)
Two principles / Gauba's three-step exposition	ANALYSIS: Rawls's first principle secures equal basic liberties; his second contains fair equality of opportunity and the difference principle. Gauba lists the two parts of the second principle separately for teaching clarity (PDF p.448).
Exploitation / inequality	FACT: For Marxism, the central wrong is not bare inequality but unpaid surplus labour made possible by capitalist property relations. (PDF pp.453-455)
Recognition / redistribution	ANALYSIS: Feminist and subaltern sections show that justice cannot be reduced to income or wealth alone because power, dignity, participation and status are also unequally distributed. (PDF pp.464-469)
Isolated self / situated self	FACT: Liberal justice is criticized for abstracting individuals from social ends; communitarian justice sees persons as embedded in social roles, practices and traditions. (PDF pp.469-472)
Simple equality / complex equality	FACT: Walzer rejects uniform equalization of all goods and instead prevents one sphere, especially money, from dominating all other spheres. (PDF pp.472-473)

5. Thinker-by-thinker positions

Thinker	Position used in this topic
Rawls	FACT: Justice as fairness, chosen behind a veil of ignorance, yields two lexically ordered principles: equal basic liberties; then fair opportunity plus the difference principle (PDF pp.447-450).
Nozick	FACT: Justice is title-based, not end-state-based; just acquisition, voluntary transfer and rectification jointly limit legitimate redistribution (PDF pp.450-452).
Marx and Engels	FACT: Capitalism is unjust because labour creates value while capital appropriates surplus; communism aims to abolish private ownership of major productive assets and class rule. (PDF pp.453-459)
Lenin / Mao	FACT: Gauba uses them to explain book-period socialist-state functions such as socialization, planning and ideological-cultural transformation in transition. (PDF pp.456-458)
Laski / Durbin	FACT: Democratic socialism seeks social justice through democratic method, welfare provision and civil liberties. (PDF pp.460-461)
Proudhon / Bakunin / Kropotkin / Tolstoy / Gandhi / Bookchin	FACT: These anarchist or anarchist-adjacent figures share suspicion of coercive authority, though they diverge on violence, property and moral regeneration. (PDF pp.462-464)
Wollstonecraft / J.S. Mill	FACT: Early feminism demands equal rational and civic standing for women against inherited legal-political exclusion. (PDF pp.465-466)
Gramsci	FACT: Subaltern analysis explains how domination persists through hegemony that presents elite rule as universal interest. (PDF pp.468-469)
MacIntyre / Sandel / Taylor / Walzer	FACT: Communitarian thinkers dispute the atomistic self, liberal neutrality and universal distributive formulas detached from community meanings. (PDF pp.470-473)

6. Competing perspectives

- FACT: Rawlsian liberalism asks what fair persons would choose if stripped of bargaining advantage. (PDF pp.447-448)
- FACT: Libertarianism asks whether each holding arose through just acquisition and transfer and whether prior injustice has been rectified (PDF pp.450-452).
- FACT: Marxism asks who owns production, who performs labour and who captures surplus. (PDF pp.453-455)
- FACT: Democratic socialism asks how social justice can be constitutional, democratic and welfare-oriented without dictatorship. (PDF pp.459-461)
- FACT: Anarchism asks whether coercive institutions themselves are the deepest injustice. (PDF pp.461-464)
- FACT: Feminism asks whether apparently neutral arrangements are actually built on gendered subordination and exclusion from power. (PDF pp.464-468)
- FACT: Subaltern theory asks who produces social wealth yet remains marginalized because elite hegemony naturalizes unequal reward. (PDF pp.467-469)
- FACT: Communitarianism asks whether justice can be understood without a prior account of shared ends, virtues and the meanings of goods in a community. (PDF pp.469-473)
- ANALYSIS: The progression also shows a movement from individual-centered justice theories to structurally and socially embedded justice theories.

- ANALYSIS: Together, these perspectives widen justice from distribution of goods to structures of ownership, authority, dignity and belonging; recognition remains a separately tagged extension.

7. Internal debates and criticisms

- FACT: Gauba records collectivist criticism that Rawls may legitimate capitalism by allowing large inequalities so long as the worst-off improve somewhat. (PDF p.448)
- FACT: He records Marxist criticism that Rawls's veil of ignorance detaches justice from real class and property relations. (PDF p.449)
- FACT: He records libertarian criticism that Rawls sacrifices liberty and incentives for equality. (PDF p.449)
- FACT: He records communitarian criticism that Rawls's neutrality evades the pursuit of the common good. (PDF p.449)
- FACT: Gauba partly answers these by reading Rawls as a convergence of libertarian, egalitarian and communitarian elements. (PDF pp.449-450)
- ANALYSIS: Necessary/sufficient correction: improving the least advantaged is not sufficient to justify an inequality if equal basic liberties or fair equality of opportunity are violated.
- FACT: Nozick is criticized for treating welfare taxation as morally suspect while leaving structurally generated market injustice untouched. (PDF p.452)
- ANALYSIS: Historical-title correction: present consent is not sufficient for Nozickian justice when the asset's acquisition history is unjust; rectification is a constitutive third principle.
- FACT: Gauba's own Marxist conclusion is double-edged: communism is ethically attractive, yet new dominance may reappear through bureaucratic or political power even after private property is abolished. (PDF p.459)
- FACT: Democratic socialism is normatively attractive but institutionally fragile because it depends on strong public opinion, resources and incentives. (PDF p.461)
- FACT: Anarchism is criticized as fascinating but programmatically weak, overly optimistic about human nature and inattentive to regulatory needs of large modern societies. (PDF p.464)
- FACT: Walzer's communitarianism is criticized by Gauba for strong moral reasoning but weak political machinery. (PDF p.473)
- ANALYSIS: Feminist and subaltern critiques additionally expose a blind spot in many older distributive theories: persons enter distribution already marked by hierarchy, dependence and damaged status; "misrecognition" is later recognition-theory vocabulary, not Gauba's own term.
- WRONG: Communitarian critique = rejection of rights. -> FACT: Gauba's communitarian section critiques liberal abstraction and neutrality, not the very possibility of norm-guided justice. (PDF pp.469-473)

8. Comparative matrix

Semantic table split - Perspective

- **Perspective:** Rawlsian liberal
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Primary goods are governed by two principles: equal basic liberties; then fair opportunity and the difference principle (PDF pp.447-448).
- **State:** FACT: Redistributive and regulatory; government may pursue distributive justice, not mere order-maintenance. (PDF pp.448-450)
- **Property:** FACT: Capitalism may remain only under prior fairness conditions.
- **Equality:** FACT: Benefit to the least advantaged is tested only after liberty and opportunity requirements.
- **Community:** ANALYSIS: Gauba's chain-connection illustration stresses interdependence but does not replace lexical priority.
- **Critique:** FACT: Vulnerable to charges of legitimizing inequality and abstracting from actual power relations.
- **Perspective:** Libertarian (Nozick)
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Historical justice requires acquisition, transfer and rectification, not patterned redistribution (PDF pp.450-452).

- **State:** FACT: Minimal protective state and correction of proven title injustice; Gauba also mentions limited common services.
- **Property:** FACT: Strong self-ownership and property, subject to just title, non-force/non-fraud and the acquisition proviso.
- **Equality:** FACT: Inequality is acceptable only if the historical process is just.
- **Community:** FACT: Community cannot automatically conscript one person's talents for another's benefit.
- **Critique:** FACT: Rectification is difficult to specify, and structural starting inequalities complicate claims of voluntariness.
- **Perspective:** Marxist
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Need-based communist distribution is normatively superior, but justice within capitalism is structurally blocked by exploitation. (PDF pp.453, 458-459)
- **State:** FACT: Transitional socialist state suppresses reaction and socializes production before eventual withering away. (PDF pp.455-458)
- **Property:** FACT: Distinguishes personal property from exploitative private ownership of major means of production. (PDF pp.458-459)
- **Equality:** FACT: Equality means ending class exploitation, not merely redistributing wages. (PDF pp.453-459)
- **Community:** FACT: Final aim is classless association where each person's development supports all. (PDF pp.458-459)
- **Critique:** FACT: Underestimates reappearance of domination through political-bureaucratic power. (PDF p.459)
- **Perspective:** Democratic-socialist
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Social justice through partial socialization, welfare, education, culture and public services. (PDF pp.459-461)
- **State:** FACT: Constitutional-democratic welfare state with party competition and civil liberties. (PDF pp.460-461)
- **Property:** FACT: Mixed economy; essential sectors may be publicly owned without total abolition of property. (PDF p.459)
- **Equality:** FACT: Seeks both socio-economic equality and freedom of expression, religion and movement. (PDF pp.459-460)
- **Community:** FACT: Community is strengthened through democratic solidarity, public opinion and social citizenship. (PDF pp.460-461)
- **Critique:** FACT: Hard to sustain without resources, strong civic will and careful incentive design. (PDF p.461)
- **Perspective:** Anarchist
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Justice through voluntary cooperation, mutual aid, decentralized federation or communal sharing. (PDF pp.461-464)
- **State:** FACT: State is intrinsically coercive and should be abolished or progressively rendered unnecessary. (PDF pp.461-464)
- **Property:** FACT: Property is often seen as domination, though strands vary from mutualism to anarchist communism. (PDF pp.462-464)
- **Equality:** FACT: Equality means absence of hierarchy, privilege and coercive domination. (PDF pp.462-464)
- **Community:** FACT: Small-scale solidarity and federation replace centralized authority. (PDF pp.462-464)
- **Critique:** FACT: Lacks workable large-scale mechanism and underestimates mixed human motives and ecological-regulatory constraints. (PDF p.464)
- **Perspective:** Feminist
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Justice must redistribute rights, opportunities, education, representation and power to correct gendered disadvantage. (PDF pp.465-468)
- **State:** FACT: State action is often necessary for rights, reservations, maternity support and equal participation. (PDF pp.466-468)
- **Property:** FACT: Historic exclusion from property and economic power is part of injustice. (PDF pp.465-468)

- **Equality:** FACT: Equality includes effective status, empowerment and share in decision-making, not formal sameness alone. (PDF pp.466-468)
- **Community:** FACT: Community traditions are scrutinized when they naturalize patriarchal roles or deny autonomy. (PDF pp.465-467)
- **Critique:** FACT: Challenges the translation of biological difference into social and political subordination. (PDF pp.465-468)
- **Perspective:** Subaltern
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Justice requires equitable shares, protection of rights and restoration of dignity for oppressed groups. (PDF pp.467-469)
- **State:** FACT: The state, public discourse and historiography must cease privileging elites and protect subaltern agency. (PDF pp.468-469)
- **Property:** FACT: Economic exploitation matters, but hegemony also works through non-property hierarchies such as caste, culture and region. (PDF pp.467-469)
- **Equality:** FACT: Equality means ending permanent subordination and rewarding contribution fairly. (PDF pp.468-469)
- **Community:** FACT: Community is fractured by ruling-class hegemony unless subaltern voices organize and rewrite the social narrative. (PDF pp.468-469)
- **Critique:** FACT: Exposes elite theory as ideological because it naturalizes unequal rule and reward. (PDF pp.468-469)
- **Perspective:** Communitarian
- **Distribution rule:** FACT: Justice is discovered within shared practices and sphere-specific meanings; Walzer prefers complex equality over uniform leveling. (PDF pp.469-473)
- **State:** FACT: State may sustain common goods and prevent domination of one sphere by another, especially money over politics, education or health. (PDF pp.472-473)
- **Property:** FACT: Property has no right to colonize all other goods or social meanings. (PDF pp.472-473)
- **Equality:** FACT: Equality is complex: inequality in one sphere should not automatically buy superiority in all others. (PDF pp.472-473)
- **Community:** FACT: Persons are situated, embodied and embedded selves constituted by ends discovered in community. (PDF pp.470-472)
- **Critique:** FACT: Strong on moral diagnosis, weaker on enforceable political mechanism. (PDF p.473)

9. Application without current-affairs dependence

- ANALYSIS: In a scholarship-distribution question, Rawls asks whether the rule protects fair opportunity and the least advantaged; Nozick asks whether anyone's earnings are being unjustly appropriated to fund it.
- ANALYSIS: In a land-reform question, Marxism asks whether ownership patterns institutionalize exploitation; democratic socialism asks how reform can be constitutional and welfare-enhancing.
- ANALYSIS: In a workplace-gender question, feminist justice asks whether apparently neutral rules reproduce exclusion from power, promotion or property.
- ANALYSIS: In a question on caste- or class-based exclusion, subaltern justice asks whether the dominant group's worldview has been normalized as universal interest.
- ANALYSIS: In a question on admission, office, health care or political office, Walzer's "complex equality" helps show why money should not purchase every social good.
- ANALYSIS: In a question on village self-rule or decentralization, anarchist and Gandhian strands can be contrasted with socialist and welfare-state expectations about regulation.

10. UPSC answer-engine prompts

- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Compare Rawls and Nozick on justice." -> Organize by distributive object, method, liberty, property, state and treatment of inequality.
- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Is justice mainly about distribution or domination?" -> Start with Rawls/Nozick, then widen to Marxist, feminist and subaltern critiques.
- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Discuss communitarian critique of liberal justice." -> Contrast right over good, isolated self over embedded self, and simple equality over complex equality.
- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Can socialism and democracy be combined?" -> Use democratic socialism as the middle path between Marxist revolution and laissez-faire liberalism.
- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Why is recognition central to justice?" -> First use feminist and subaltern sections to show how hierarchy distorts reward, status and dignity; then add Fraser/Honneth explicitly as a supplementary recognition-theory route.
- FACT: **Verified PYQ (2023)**: "What is meant by justice as fairness? Explain Rawls' theory of

justice." The high-scoring answer must include the original position, veil of ignorance, two principles, lexical priority and at least one criticism.

11. Cross-links and exclusions

- ANALYSIS: Foundation companion:
`Political-Theory/basic/20_Diverse-Perspectives-on-Justice.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Liberal and libertarian background:
`Political-Theory/advanced/03_Liberalism-and-Neoliberalism.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Socialist, anarchist and Gandhian background:
`Political-Theory/advanced/04_Marxism-and-Neo-Marxism.md` and
`Political-Theory/advanced/05_Socialism-Fascism-Anarchism-and-Gandhism.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Feminist and communitarian background:
`Political-Theory/advanced/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md` and
`Political-Theory/advanced/07_Nature-of-Politics-and-Communitarianism.md`.
- ANALYSIS: State-role boundary:
`Political-Theory/advanced/10_State-Civil-Society-Nation-and-Internationalism.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Global, intergenerational and environmental-justice route:
`Political-Theory/advanced/19_Justice-Concepts-and-Dimensions.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Module frame and topic map: `Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md` and
`Political-Theory/README.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Exclusion: this file does not move into present-day welfare statistics, court doctrine or current policy design.

12. Factual-risk checks

- FACT: Gauba's descriptions of Soviet Russia, Maoist China, East Europe, UNDP ranking tables and late-20th-century market examples are historical or book-period anchors, not current data. (PDF pp.456-468)
- FACT: Feminist numerical claims and development rankings are reproduced by Gauba from older sources and must remain dated if cited. (PDF pp.465-468)
- FACT: Walzer, Sandel, Taylor and MacIntyre are used here only through Gauba's 2009 chapter framing, not through their later debates. (PDF pp.470-473)
- ANALYSIS: The table headings "distribution rule / state / property / equality / community / critique" are exam-use synthesis headings imposed on the chapter for comparison.
- ANALYSIS: The minority-recognition and anti-domination language used to connect feminist and subaltern sections is a pedagogical synthesis drawn from Gauba's descriptions of subordination.
- WRONG: Do not collapse communitarianism into authoritarian moral absolutism or Nozick into hostility to justice.

13. Sources, metadata and tags

- FACT: Primary source used directly: Gauba, Ch.20, PDF pp.446-473.
- FACT: Rawls and Nozick anchors: PDF pp.447-452.
- FACT: Marxist, democratic-socialist and anarchist anchors: PDF pp.453-464.
- FACT: Feminist, subaltern and communitarian anchors: PDF pp.465-473.
- ANALYSIS: All comparative compression, exam prompts and cross-perspective headings are explicitly marked as synthesis.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

EMBEDDED TWELVE-PANEL ASCII REVISION ATLAS

This text edition preserves the same source-grounded revision route as the separate printable ASCII deliverable.

ASCII PANEL 1/12 - Perspective Map, Stakes and Essential Vocabulary

CENTRAL FOCUS

Perspective Map, Stakes and Essential Vocabulary

[1] Gauba presents rival perspectives on justice rather than one settled formula.

|

v

[2] Rawls, Nozick, Marxism, socialism, anarchism, feminism and communitarianism differ.

|

v

[3] Every doctrine identifies a standard, an object, an institution and a remedy.

|

v

[4] Objects include liberties, offices, holdings, labour, status, voice and common goods.

|

v

[5] Institutions include the state, market, property regime, family and public culture.

|

v

[6] Redistribution, rectification, transformation and recognition are not interchangeable.

|

v

[7] The topic rewards comparison across rule, state, property, equality and community.

|

v

[8] A strong answer names the justice standard before judging an outcome.

|

v

VERDICT -> The chapter is comparative by design.

ANSWER USE -> Name the rival standard of justice first.

ASCII PANEL 2/12 - The Eight-Perspective Chapter Spine

CENTRAL FOCUS

The Eight-Perspective Chapter Spine

- [1] Rawls tests institutions through fair choice and ordered distributive principles.
|
v
- [2] Nozick tests holdings through acquisition, transfer and rectification.
|
v
- [3] Marxism targets exploitation, surplus value and productive ownership.
|
v
- [4] Democratic socialism joins social justice to welfare, liberty and competition.
|
v
- [5] Anarchism treats coercive hierarchy and domination as the central danger.
|
v
- [6] Feminist justice exposes gendered burdens hidden by formally equal rules.
|
v
- [7] Subaltern justice centres dignity, contribution, voice and structural exclusion.
|
v
- [8] Communitarianism begins from embedded selves and socially interpreted goods.
|
v

VERDICT -> Rawls requires ordered principles, not one slogan.

ANSWER USE -> State liberty, opportunity and difference in sequence.

ASCII PANEL 3/12 - Rawls, Nozick and Controlling Distinctions

CENTRAL FOCUS

Rawls, Nozick and Controlling Distinctions

- [1] Rawls does not defend simple equality of outcome.
|
v
- [2] Original position and veil of ignorance model fair choice under uncertainty.
|
v
- [3] Equal basic liberties come first, then fair opportunity, then difference.
|
v
- [4] Primary goods identify the liberties, opportunities and means being distributed.
|
v
- [5] Nozick does not deny justice; he denies patterned redistribution as the master test.
|
v
- [6] Entitlement theory turns on acquisition, transfer and rectification together.
|
v
- [7] Wilt Chamberlain attacks end-state patterning through voluntary exchange.
|
v
- [8] The water-source case shows that acquisition is not morally unlimited.
|
v

VERDICT -> Nozick's history matters as much as present consent.

ANSWER USE -> Mention rectification when title history is disputed.

ASCII PANEL 4/12 - Thinkers and Rival Standards of Justice

CENTRAL FOCUS

Thinkers and Rival Standards of Justice

- [1] Marxist critique targets exploitation, surplus value and productive control.
|
v
- [2] Democratic socialism keeps social justice but rejects dictatorship.
|
v
- [3] Anarchism values voluntary cooperation while questioning coercive authority.
|
v
- [4] Feminist justice tests burdens in property, care, work and representation.
|
v
- [5] Gramsci explains how hegemony can make inequality appear consensual.
|
v
- [6] Walzer's complex equality blocks dominance across distinct social spheres.
|
v
- [7] Sen's capability lens asks what resources enable persons actually to do.
|
v
- [8] Fraser's parity lens joins distribution, status and peer participation.
|
v

VERDICT -> Socialism divides over freedom, method and state form.

ANSWER USE -> Separate welfare constitutionalism from centralism.

ASCII PANEL 5/12 - Illustrative Cases and Evidence Units

CENTRAL FOCUS

Illustrative Cases and Evidence Units

- [1] Wilt Chamberlain tests whether voluntary transfer may upset a pattern.
|
v
- [2] The sole water source tests whether acquisition worsens others' position.
|
v
- [3] A clean sale after dispossession shows why rectification cannot be omitted.
|
v
- [4] Unpaid labour captured in production illustrates the surplus-value critique.
|
v
- [5] A neutral rule with unequal care burdens illustrates feminist correction.
|
v
- [6] Cash transfers with continuing stigma illustrate mis-recognition.
|
v
- [7] Wealth purchasing office or education illustrates cross-sphere dominance.
|
v
- [8] Antyodaya is an Indian policy illustration, not proof of one justice theory.
|
v

VERDICT -> Anarchism critiques domination, not coordination as such.

ANSWER USE -> Balance voluntary order with the scale objection.

ASCII PANEL 6/12 - The Six-Axis Comparative Matrix

CENTRAL FOCUS

The Six-Axis Comparative Matrix

- [1] Rule axis: patterned fairness, historical entitlement or anti-domination.
|
v
- [2] State axis: redistributive authority, minimal protection or decentralisation.
|
v
- [3] Property axis: primary goods, title history or productive control.
|
v
- [4] Equality axis: formal treatment, fair opportunity, capability or status parity.
|
v
- [5] Community axis: isolated chooser, embedded self or sphere-specific meanings.
|
v
- [6] Critique axis: abstraction, history, exploitation, patriarchy or hegemony.
|
v
- [7] The same policy can pass one axis while failing another.
|
v
- [8] A comparative answer should explain conflict before offering a graded synthesis.
|
v

VERDICT -> Formal equality can leave structural subordination intact.

ANSWER USE -> Show why correction is not identical treatment.

ASCII PANEL 7/12 - Trap Repair, Boundaries and PYQ Routes

CENTRAL FOCUS

Trap Repair, Boundaries and PYQ Routes

- [1] Trap: Rawls orders principles; he does not permit liberty-for-income trades.
|
v
- [2] Trap: Nozick includes rectification; recent consent does not cleanse old injustice.
|
v
- [3] Trap: Marxian exploitation is structural, not merely a complaint about low wages.
|
v
- [4] Trap: communitarian goods do not license cultural uniformity or silenced dissent.
|
v
- [5] Capability and parity are bounded extensions, not Gauba chapter vocabulary.
|
v
- [6] Postcolonial and global justice remain routed outside this owner.
|
v
- [7] Verified cross-applied PYQs retain their Philosophy Paper II ownership.
|
v
- [8] Democratisation, backsliding and movement processes remain Topic 23 bridges.
|
v

VERDICT -> Hegemony explains why injustice can appear normal.

ANSWER USE -> Link subaltern critique to public meaning and reward.

ASCII PANEL 8/12 - Revision Spine and Directive Control

CENTRAL FOCUS

Revision Spine and Directive Control

- [1] Revise each perspective through standard, object, institution and remedy.
 - |
 - v
- [2] Define asks for conceptual boundaries before examples.
 - |
 - v
- [3] Compare requires a common axis and a point of real disagreement.
 - |
 - v
- [4] Discuss requires claim, support, objection and balanced conclusion.
 - |
 - v
- [5] Critically examine requires an internal limit, not a decorative criticism.
 - |
 - v
- [6] Use one evidence unit only after stating the mechanism it illustrates.
 - |
 - v
- [7] Route the answer through thesis, distinction, objection-reply and verdict.
 - |
 - v
- [8] Keep quotations paraphrased unless wording and ownership are verified.
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> Community meanings qualify but do not abolish justice.

ANSWER USE -> Use Walzer to block one sphere dominating another.

ASCII PANEL 9/12 - Argument Reconstruction and Objection-Reply Chains

CENTRAL FOCUS

Argument Reconstruction and Objection-Reply Chains

- [1] Rawls objection: abstract choice may understate history and social identity.
 - |
 - v
- [2] Rawls reply: the device models fair terms, not an empirical bargaining meeting.
 - |
 - v
- [3] Nozick objection: title history may be unknowable and background power unequal.
 - |
 - v
- [4] Nozick reply: uncertainty strengthens the need for rectification rather than patterning.
 - |
 - v
- [5] Marxist objection: centralised transformation may threaten liberty and opposition.
 - |
 - v
- [6] Anarchist objection: voluntary order faces scale, coordination and enforcement problems.
 - |
 - v
- [7] Communitarian objection: shared meanings may conceal hierarchy and exclusion.
 - |
 - v
- [8] Synthesis must preserve distribution, history, status and reviewable power.
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> The six-axis grid prevents descriptive overflow.

ANSWER USE -> Compare rule, state, property, equality, community and critique.

ASCII PANEL 10/12 - Indian Applications, Quotation Safety and MCQ Ledger

CENTRAL FOCUS

Indian Applications, Quotation Safety and MCQ Ledger

- [1] Antyodaya illustrates targeted public action but proves no single doctrine.
|
v
- [2] Indian application should test resources, opportunity, dignity, voice and power.
|
v
- [3] The 44th-Amendment property bridge must not be cited as Gauba chapter evidence.
|
v
- [4] Capability and parity require explicit supplementary attribution.
|
v
- [5] Recognition language must remain a bridge rather than an invented chapter owner.
|
v
- [6] MCQ labels must preserve narrow distinctions among adjacent standards.
|
v
- [7] Current examples require dates and source limits before analytical use.
|
v
- [8] Quotation safety means named propositions are preferable to invented wording.
|
v

VERDICT -> Supplementary bridges must remain explicitly bounded.

ANSWER USE -> Tag capability and parity as extensions, not Gauba terms.

ASCII PANEL 11/12 - MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

CENTRAL FOCUS

MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

- [1] Primary goods and capability differ between distributed means and real freedom.
|
v
- [2] Original position and veil differ between a choice device and its information rule.
|
v
- [3] Liberty, fair opportunity and difference form an ordered Rawlsian sequence.
|
v
- [4] Entitlement, self-ownership and minimal state are related but non-identical.
|
v
- [5] Wilt, water-source and rectification cases test different historical questions.
|
v
- [6] Formal equality, feminist correction and parity test different exclusion mechanisms.
|
v
- [7] Embedded self and complex equality address identity and sphere dominance separately.
|
v
- [8] Close-option practice should identify the decisive threshold before selecting.
|
v

VERDICT -> Cross-application never transfers Philosophy ownership.

ANSWER USE -> Keep the original Philosophy owner explicit.

ASCII PANEL 12/12 - PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

CENTRAL FOCUS

PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

- [1] Six verified PYQs remain cross-applied under Philosophy ownership.
 - |
 - v
- [2] Rawls, Nozick, Sen, Plato and Mill route through Social and Political Ideals.
 - |
 - v
- [3] Political Theory borrows tested questions without claiming primary ownership.
 - |
 - v
- [4] Original Topic 20 practice must remain distinguishable from transferred PYQs.
 - |
 - v
- [5] A 10-mark answer needs definition, mechanism, one criticism and a tight verdict.
 - |
 - v
- [6] A 15-mark answer adds comparison and an objection-reply chain.
 - |
 - v
- [7] A 20-mark answer integrates rival standards, application and graded synthesis.
 - |
 - v
- [8] Every conclusion should state which justice dimension the preferred view secures.
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> Topic 20 ends where Topic 23's democratic bridges begin.

ANSWER USE -> Route democratisation and backsliding forward to Topic 23.

ONE-PAGE CONCEPT GRID

Concept / thinker	Exam-ready formulation
Primary goods	Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
Original position	Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
Veil of ignorance	The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
Equal basic liberties	Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty.
Fair equality of opportunity	Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality.
Difference principle	Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged.
Entitlement theory	Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
Subaltern	Groups kept in subordinate, exploited or marginalized positions by structural inequalities and hegemonic domination.
Situated / embedded self	Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
John Rawls	Justice as fairness through two lexically ordered principles: equal basic liberties; then fair opportunity plus the difference principle, chosen in the original position. Gauba explains the second principle's two parts as separate steps (PDF pp.447-450).
Robert Nozick	Justice as entitlement grounded jointly in self-ownership, just initial acquisition, voluntary transfer and rectification under a minimal protective state (PDF pp.450-452).
Marx and Engels	Capitalist injustice lies in exploitation of labour, surplus value and private ownership of major means of production; communist society aims to end class domination.

CORE REVISION SPINE

- Gauba opens the chapter by treating justice as a field of many rival perspectives rather than one settled formula. (PDF p.446)
- Feminist and subaltern perspectives insist that justice must also address structurally subordinated groups, not only formal market or contract rules. (PDF pp.464-469)
- Scope boundary: this canonical owner covers Gauba's eight chapter-framed perspectives. Capability and recognition are separately sourced extensions; multicultural, environmental/intergenerational, postcolonial and global justice remain external cross-routes unless independently sourced in their own owners.
- Rawlsian liberal justice centres on primary goods, original position, equal basic liberties, fair equality of opportunity, and the difference principle. (PDF pp.447-450)
- Nozickian libertarian justice centres on self-ownership and justice in acquisition, transfer and rectification under a minimal state. (PDF pp.450-452)
- Anarchists attack coercive authority itself and imagine justice through voluntary cooperation, decentralization and anti-domination. (PDF pp.461-464)
- Communitarians criticize the isolated or unencumbered self and relocate justice within embedded selves, shared goods and community meanings. (PDF pp.469-473)
- UPSC key: every justice theory answers six hidden questions—who gets what, by what rule, through which state, with what property regime, in what kind of community, and against which injustice.

- This chapter is the direct sequel to the conceptual discussion of justice because it asks how rival traditions operationalize justice in actual distribution. (PDF pp.446-447)
- It clarifies why justice debates cannot be reduced to one axis like liberty alone or equality alone. (PDF pp.448-450, 469-473)
- It is also the safest way to avoid caricatures such as "Rawls = equal outcome" or "Nozick = no justice."
- Use this chapter whenever a question asks whether justice lies in fair procedure, entitlement, need, community, or emancipation from domination. Recognition may be added only as the separately sourced Fraser/Honneth extension in Section 13.

HIGH-RISK TRAPS

- Trap repair: Rawls wants identical outcomes for all. -> Rawls permits inequality after liberty and fair opportunity, provided it benefits the least advantaged. (PDF p.448)
- Trap repair: The difference principle alone is enough to justify an inequality. -> Equal basic liberties and fair equality of opportunity have lexical priority.
- Trap repair: Nozick is anti-justice. -> Nozick proposes a full theory of justice, but one centred on entitlement rather than redistribution. (PDF pp.451-452)
- Trap repair: Any voluntary market transfer is just for Nozick. -> The transfer must rest on just title; acquisition, transfer and rectification form a connected historical test.
- Trap repair: Marxism has nothing to do with justice. -> Gauba says that would be too strong, because Marx condemns exploitation and endorses superior distributive principles in a classless order. (PDF p.453)
- Trap repair: Democratic socialism is just Marxism without elections. -> It explicitly insists on freedom of thought, multi-party competition and opposition rights. (PDF pp.460-461)
- Trap repair: Feminism only demands that women be treated exactly like men in every situation. -> Gauba also notes claims for maternity benefits and compensatory support rooted in actual disadvantage. (PDF pp.466-468)
- Trap repair: Communitarian criticism means justice should give way to blind conformity. -> The criticism is directed at the abstract self and ethical neutrality, not at the very idea of justice. (PDF pp.469-473)

ANSWER SPINE

1. Define the exact doctrine or controversy in the question.
2. State a qualified thesis before narration begins.
3. Reconstruct premises, mechanism and conclusion.
4. Add named thinkers and one precise distinction.
5. Present the strongest objection, reply and residual limitation.
6. End with a graded verdict tied to the directive.

COMPLETE TOPIC CHECKLIST

- **Gauba core sequence:** Rawls -> Nozick -> Marxism -> democratic socialism -> anarchism -> feminist and subaltern enlargements -> communitarian critique.
- **Rawls control:** equal basic liberties first; fair equality of opportunity precedes the difference principle.
- **Nozick control:** acquisition, transfer and rectification are all necessary.
- **Marxist control:** exploitation and surplus value are structural, not merely complaints about low wages.
- **Communitarian control:** embedded self and common goods do not license authoritarian homogenisation.
- **Final verdict:** this topic compares rival standards of justice rather than announcing one uncontested doctrine.

SUPPLEMENTARY-EXTENSION BOUNDARY

Extension	Safe use	Boundary
Capability approach	Sen/Nussbaum on real freedom and unequal conversion.	Use as supplementary, not as Gauba's own chapter vocabulary.
Parity of participation	Fraser on distribution, status and peer standing.	Keep distinct from Gauba-grounded feminist and subaltern material unless tagged.
Mis-recognition	Status injury and blocked equal standing.	Use only as a bounded extension, not as core Gauba wording.

FACT-RISK CAUTIONS

- Do **not** cite the 44th-Amendment property bridge as Gauba chapter evidence.
- Do **not** present capability or parity language as Gauba's own vocabulary.
- Do **not** invent direct quotations for Rawls, Nozick or Walzer.
- Do **not** reroute verified Philosophy PYQs into Political Theory ownership.

CROSS-APPLIED PHILOSOPHY OWNERSHIP

Route	Primary Philosophy owner
Rawls / Nozick / Sen / Plato / J.S. Mill	Social and Political Ideals
Marxism / anarchism	Political Ideologies
Recognition-adjacent and multicultural routes	Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism
Gender equality and corrective support	Gender Discrimination
Caste and Ambedkarian status injury	Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar
Capability and ecology routes	Development and Social Progress

FORWARD BOUNDARY TO TOPIC 23

- **Democratisation, democratic backsliding** and **social movements** belong to **Topic 23** as supplemental bounded bridges.
- Topic 20 may supply only the justice standards later used to judge those democratic processes.
- Topic 20 must not silently absorb regime-change or movement ownership.

ANSWER-WRITING GRID

NAME THE STANDARD -> fairness | entitlement | exploitation | anti-domination | community
 |
 v
 IDENTIFY THE OBJECT -> liberties | offices | holdings | labour | status | voice
 |
 v
 TEST THE INSTITUTION -> state | market | property regime | social hierarchy | public culture
 |
 v
 RUN THE CRITICISM -> history | incentive | structural inequality | hegemony | abstraction
 |
 v
 GRADED VERDICT -> justified distribution + defensible status + reviewable power